

Private Worship - Worshipping God in Truth

We left off in John 4, so go over there. We have been looking at "in spirit and in truth," though we have not gotten very far.

Jesus was talking to the Samaritan woman in verse 22:

"Ye worship ye know not what:
we know what we worship:
for salvation is of the Jews."

Then He goes on:

"But the hour cometh,
and now is,
when the true worshippers shall worship the Father
in spirit and in truth:
for the Father seeketh such to worship him.
God is a Spirit:
and they that worship him must worship him
in spirit and in truth."

What broke this open for me was when He whispered, "Break the hour down on the millennial time clock." We know that one day is as a thousand years and a thousand years as one day. That calculates to about forty-one years, in other words, a generation.

So He was telling the Samaritan woman, "The hour has come. Now it is here. The generation has arrived when everything is going to change."

Jesus was occupying that hour. The hour now is when the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and in truth.

He was saying, "I am going to give My life. I am going to be crucified and sit down at the right hand of the Father. You will be baptized into My death. You will be made alive with Me. You will receive a new nature."

The phrase "in spirit" means you are going to receive a new nature that makes you a partaker of His divine nature. When you receive that, you will be able to worship Him in spirit.

Old Testament saints could not give Him what you can give Him. They could worship Him out of their soul, but God had to pull up just short of the unregenerated nature because it had no fellowship with Him.

That unregenerated nature is the same one Paul talks about in Romans 7. When the Ten Commandments were delivered to the Jew, there was just one problem: they had a nature that could not keep them.

"The good that I would I do not:
but the evil which I would not,
that I do."

So Paul confessed, "It is no more I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me." Being unregenerated, the place where sin dwelled in him was his death nature.

God had to pull up just short of the part that really has the capacity to know Him: the human spirit.

Most of the worship presented to Him by Old Testament saints, unless they were prophesying about your time, was worship given to Him through the soul, not through a nature made partaker of His divine nature.

When Jesus said the Father "seeketh such" to worship Him, many books say that means God is looking for worshipers. Technically, that is true. But it is not the root of the revelation in this chapter.

When He said He seeketh such to worship Him, it meant He did everything necessary, waiting out the dispensation of four thousand years. Before the flood, He worked everything He could. After the flood, through Noah and leading up to the promise given to Abraham, God worked the dispensations, waiting.

He waited for the first Man to appear on this planet, Jesus, born spiritually alive, who had a nature like His Father's. Then there could be a rapport and a flow of nature and worship that can only take place between two of the same kind.

Not between a duck and a chicken, but between two ducks.

You have something you can give Him. You have something He wants.

There is not much you have that you can give Him except you, because that is what He came back for: you.

All your gifts, everything you try, promise, want, or do, He is not as interested in those as He is in you. You are the prized possession. You are really the only thing He wants out of this whole thing.

Your checkbooks do not impress Him. People act like they do, but no. You have one thing He wants: you. And He wants you forever.

He thought He would try to talk you into starting now. He thought it would be good if He could have you long before He came back to get you. In this perverse and backwards generation, He could light your candle, and in the midst of darkness you could stand as a testimony that He lives, that you trust Him, that He wants you, and that you have given yourself to Him.

"Master, even the devils are subject unto us through Thy name."

Jesus had to calm them down.

"Yes, but you do not understand."

"I said, 'Devil, go,' and he went!"

"Yes, but you do not understand."

"Jesus, I laid hands on the sick and they recovered!"

"Yes, I understand."

They were more shocked that the devil had to come out than the devil was. They said, "Come out," and he came out, and they went, "Whoa."

Jesus said, "I am glad you are glad that devils have to move when you tell them to in My name, because I am going to pay the price for that soon. Right now you have My mantle. I am loaning it to you. It works like the real thing, so go tell them again, 'Get out,' and they will leave."

But then He said, "Do not rejoice that the spirits are subject unto you, but rather rejoice because your names are written in heaven."

Why? Because your Father wants you to begin the journey of knowing Him. Devils will come out, but you are the one He wants.

The devil will make you feel small, as if you are accomplishing nothing, sitting in a little chair with all your little problems, lifting your hands and saying, "Hallelujah. I worship You and glorify You."

After a while, things calm down a little, then the problems try to cave in on you again. It may not feel like you are doing much or sound like you are doing much. But trust me: you are suspending your spirit in His presence.

All that God is, His love and all those attributes He told you to add to your faith, He is able to pour into you without limit. Your human spirit has capacity to reservoir His love. When you let Him fill it up, do not think that when the feelings go, He goes with them.

When you lift your hands and get ready to put them on somebody, He is not going to take you back to the desert you came from. However much of Him you received in here will show up when you step boldly to someone and say, "Father."

Your lack will be swallowed up by the hours of presence you spent with Him, because He will show up.

Why do you think the miracle that person needs is as final as the blood of Jesus purchasing it? Because He bore our sicknesses and carried our pains. We build ourselves up in that truth.

We muster our hardest prayer and attack, but why would the path to the miracle not be as ordered and final as the miracle itself? Why would the key He gave you not be as prominent, obtainable, and direct as the miracle itself?

The path to the miracle is as final as the miracle itself.

Why do you think He said you could fight the fight before you ever laid hands on the sick person? By suspending your spirit in His presence hour after hour until it is saturated.

Are you looking for a way to walk it on purpose? Or do you want to sit around and hope someone gets something when your great person shows up and prays for them?

Do you not want to lay the path? Do you not want to attack long before you get your hands on the sick person?

God is the One wanting to pour Himself out on you. His Son paid the price, and He is waiting for the opportunity to fill your spirit until enough of Him gets through that God can do what you are asking Him to do.

Of course you have the Word, and of course He won anyway. But give me your testimonies. Let us see if anything needs to be turned up.

The problem is not whether what God said is true. The problem is whether you can believe it.

If He has charted a course to the miracle and says, "Put your foot here, and here, and here," then the next step is as deliberate as the last. Will it be a fight of faith? You had better believe it. But I am not going to fight that fight for one minute in the presence of a sick person and spend the rest of my time doing nothing.

The Father seeketh such to worship Him. He did everything He could in each dispensation, but they could not give Him what He wanted until the day He made you a partaker of His divine nature through the exceeding great and precious promises.

Back up to John 1 for a minute. God waited out the dispensations for that first Man to appear on the planet.

Adam was a figure of Him who was to come. Since Adam lost his light and his spirit went out, he became spiritually dead. The second One ever to be born on this planet the way Adam was originally born was Jesus Christ. Adam was a figure of Him who was to come before he fell to spiritual death.

A whole family of earth came from the loins of the first man Adam. To be born again, you had to be born a first time. Another Adam came to this planet, and now God is getting His family back. You are being born again from the last Adam and rejoining the family of God that you lost in the first one.

John gives the account:

"In the beginning was the Word,
and the Word was with God,
and the Word was God.
The same was in the beginning with God.
All things were made by him;
and without him was not any thing made
that was made."

That isolates Jesus as Creator in His deity. Then John switches from His deity to His humanity:

"In him was life;
and the life was the light of men.
And the light shineth in darkness;
and the darkness comprehended it not."

What life was in Him? Whatever this life was, it became the light of men. The darkness it shined into was the spiritually dead state of the entire human race. Not one person had been born spiritually alive on this planet since Adam. Not one for four thousand years.

When John said, "In Him was life," he had switched from deity to humanity. Jesus was the first Man born on this planet spiritually alive in four thousand years. In Him was life, and that life was the light of men.

When Jesus died, He received our death. We were baptized into His death so we could be quickened together in His life. That life became my light. The same life that burned in Him is now burning in me.

I have been made a partaker of His divine nature. I can now give Him the fellowship He waited through the dispensations to receive.

And I am going to do it.

John 1:14 says:

"And the Word was made flesh,
and dwelt among us,
and we beheld his glory,
the glory as of the only begotten of the Father,
full of grace and truth."

John bore witness of Him, saying, "This was He of whom I spake, He that cometh after me is preferred before me, for He was before me."

Then:

"Of his fulness have all we received,
and grace for grace.
For the law was given by Moses,
but grace and truth came by Jesus Christ."

Verse 18 says:

"No man hath seen God at any time;
the only begotten Son,
which is in the bosom of the Father,
he hath declared him."

No man. Zero.

God waited out the dispensation of four thousand years for this Man to stand on the planet and have the life He received from the Father. That life was my light. My day came. The life that was in Him is now in me, and I have something I can give Him.

John 3:34 says:

"For he whom God hath sent
speaketh the words of God:
for God giveth not the Spirit by measure unto him."

Measure means part of a whole. One-third of three-thirds is a measure of the whole. He gave the Spirit to Jesus without measure.

Some preachers say Jesus could do those miracles because He is God. Yes, but the Man Jesus was redeeming you. It was not God in His deity who came to redeem us. It was the Man.

Jesus was born spiritually alive, so why did He have to be baptized? He had to be baptized to receive the Holy Spirit. He was baptized under the shadow into your death so you could be baptized into His.

Water baptism signifies the death and burial of the old man and resurrection to the new. It is not the washing away of the filth of the flesh. It means you have accepted Christ, and the old man is being buried.

Jesus was born spiritually alive, yet He was baptized into our death under the shadow. When John brought Him up out of the water, the Holy Ghost came, because under the shadow He was walking where you walk. You cannot receive the baptism of the Holy Spirit until you are quickened into the life of Christ. Jesus' baptism symbolized His dying your death and rising from it until the day He paid the real price.

He received the Holy Spirit that day. He ministered for three and a half years with the same Holy Spirit you have.

What does "without measure" mean? He was the first Man born on this planet in four thousand years with His spirit spiritually alive, so He was the first One able to receive the baptism of the Holy Spirit into His spirit. Under the old covenant, the Spirit came upon people as a mantle for the purpose, pursuits, and plans of God, but not one time could He step into them in baptism, because they had not been born again yet.

Jesus was the first to receive the Holy Spirit into His spirit without measure in four thousand years.

Moses said, "I will see God." But Jesus said no spiritually dead man in that state had seen Him.

So God picked Moses up and put him in the cleft of the rock, a type of Christ. When God passed by, He covered him.

Not you.

When you said, "I will see Christ," God did not pick you up and put you under the shadow in a type. He picked you up and put you into the nature of Christ Himself.

When God passed by you, He did not have to cover you with His hand, because you have been born again. He did not pass you by. He stopped and stepped in without measure because you have been born again.

So I can give Him what He wants. I have a nature that puts me in fellowship with His divine nature. He waited for me for four thousand years. His life has become my light. I have been born again.

What do you think Jesus is talking about in the New Testament when He asks why a candle is lit?

Jesus used Solomon as a standard for blessing. The queen of the south came from the uttermost parts of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon. Jesus clarified by saying, "A greater than Solomon is here."

Why? The wisdom Solomon operated in under the shadow was a type of the capacity your new nature gives to your spirit.

As wise as Solomon was, he could only lead the children of Israel under the shadow to the lip of the rebirth. He could not lead them in. That is why Jesus declared, "A greater than Solomon is here."

He explained Himself in the next verse. Is a candle lit to be put under a bushel or under a table? No. It is set where all who come in can walk and operate in the light of the candle.

That candle was to that dark room what your new nature is to your spirit. It took all the darkness out of it and gave you the sight you need to see.

Solomon could only dream under the shadow. The wisdom he operated in stunned the queen of Sheba. She said the half had not been told her. She saw the majesty of the ascent into the temple, the worship, the gold apparel, the gold utensils, the silver, and the happiness of the servants who had the long duty of hearing what came from Solomon's mouth. There was no spirit left in her. She was not merely amazed. She was stunned.

All of that under the shadow was only a type of what your nature is to your spirit.

He wants you to know your candle has not been lit so you can grope around in darkness. Not only has He lit your candle, but He has sent the Holy Spirit as your guide in the midst of light.

By the time Jesus meets the Samaritan woman in John 4, are you surprised He says the Father has been seeking such? He worked every dispensation to this day, when the Man Christ would stand with a human spirit alive.

He was saying, "Samaritan woman, you are going to be made a partaker of that divine nature, and all who follow will be able to worship Me in spirit, not out of a death nature, but out of a nature that can give Me the fellowship I have longed for."

There is no distance in space or time between the Father and you. He will put Himself into instant flow and communion with you any time you need Him. Any time you have a problem, just call, and He will be there.

His grace is sufficient. You can get to Him, and He will get to you.

Do you not want some on-purpose gospel?

My God, He loves you. Why not start walking in some of it?

Are you kidding? He dared to cross the void of space, time, and spiritual death to ignite your spirit. If He would do that, what makes you think He will not cross over at any cost to fellowship with you after you have been redeemed?

Do you think He left you on a distant planet somewhere with a scroll of words? Did He abandon you to see if you would be faithful? No. He provided everything He could. Getting you back was one of the hardest things He ever did in the universe.

You were locked on the other side of a nature He could not fellowship with. There was no way for Him to get across that void except to change His form and become something that could die.

Yet He came after you.

And we have the audacity to say He needs to be coaxed. He wants your fellowship more than you want His.

Did you go after Him, or did He go after you?

You were a little hard to run down. After you tasted the sweetness of Jesus, you may have turned back to the wall two or three times and gagged on what the world offered. Yet we stand there accusing Him of having the problem and not wanting fellowship.

You are still in a body that makes you a citizen of this planet as well as the kingdom. There are many terrors around you and many people with zero hope. He left you here so that as things grow up together, you might salvage some if you want.

The devil is evangelizing them. But all heaven has been made available to you.

So what if circumstances taunt you? So what if your flesh cuts off a bigger piece of the pie than you can afford, and you are running from payday to payday? What good does it do to stand outside His presence, whining like He is doing nothing for you?

Forget the slice of flesh. Forget everything the devil is doing.

People say if there are a couple of people in strife in the service, God will not move. Come on. Do you think anyone else can keep God from doing something for you? Do you think He runs some haphazard program that works only part of the time?

Everybody could be throwing tomatoes while I minister to someone up front, and that person can still get born again. If all the unbelief in the crowd cannot stop someone from being born again, how does it stop their miracle?

It does not.

In the garden, Peter cut off the servant's ear. There was a bloody sword, an arrest underway, people running and hiding, and chaos everywhere. What a conducive atmosphere for miracles. Yet Jesus picked up the ear and put it back on.

Nobody can stop you from receiving. You are the only one who can stop you.

So pull up at the gas station before you get into the desert. There are no gas stations in the middle of the desert. Fill up before you get there.

Why make only emergency calls? "I would like to fellowship with You, but I have to make it quick. I am dying here."

This brings us to "in spirit and in truth."

The reason the devil would not come out when Jesus came down from the Mount of Transfiguration was unbelief. Before He finished teaching, He gave them two power twins that deal with that kind of unbelief:

"This kind goeth not out
but by prayer and fasting."

Prayer and fasting are power twins. They have the same purpose: to eradicate the unbelief that kept that devil from coming out. We know what prayer has to do with unbelief. We pray, minister to ourselves, faith comes by hearing, and we build ourselves up above it. Fasting also deals with unbelief, though in a different way.

When most people preach "in spirit and in truth," they leave the truth part off. If they talk about it, they often say you have to be walking in truth or free of sin to be effective. Some say if you have sin and problems in your life, God will not hear your worship until you straighten the problem out.

Contrary.

The fact that you present yourself in worship means you do not want to stay the way you are. Why would He leave you the way you are?

If you start worshipping Him with hatred toward somebody, He receives it from the other side of your hatred, out of the new nature He gave you. That hatred will have a lot of trouble surviving if you will not give up your time with God.

To say He does not hear you is an insult.

"In spirit" means Old Testament saints could not give Him this kind of worship, but you can because you are in spirit. You have become a new creation and received His nature.

Then He adds, "and in truth."

What truth is He talking about as the power twin relating to the same subject? The Old Testament saints could not worship Him in this truth, but you can. These are brother and sister, like fasting and prayer.

When you work with God out of the new nature to worship Him in spirit, you can add "in truth," because now you have a capacity to worship Him in truth. Old Testament saints did not. They did not have a nature that could understand God. You do.

They could know what He said, but they could not understand Him in the nature He exists in. They had neither the capacity of a spiritual mind nor a nature like His.

Not you.

You have a spiritual mind as standard equipment of the new creation. You have a nature that made you a partaker of His divine nature. That spiritual mind puts you within the capacity of truth and understanding of who and what God is.

Because you have that capacity, when He says, "All things are possible to him that believeth," you have the capacity to worship Him in that truth. You have the capacity to believe it, operate in it, and perform it.

Cain, my timber wolf, weighed about one hundred forty pounds. He could stand on the kitchen floor and eat off the counter without jumping up. When he was a pup, his head would pull his hind legs off the ground when he walked. Later he grew into his head.

He would get out of our backyard because fences were not a problem for him. He ate our Styrofoam Jacuzzi after chewing through the vinyl cover. One day I put an electric wire around the flap. Cain went up to it, looked at me, and knew it was a no-no. I went inside, and he watched me with those yellow wolf eyes. The moment I got out of sight, he touched it. I heard it, came out, and saw him running laps around the yard, flopping on his back and kicking all over.

He never touched it again.

I had to put him under law. He would not quit. He was tearing boards off my house. We had a pygmy goat that had a little goat, and we named it Abel. We found its little hooves. Cain and Abel did not exist well together.

Cain would get out and roam the neighborhood. He would eat the neighbors' cats and chickens. He would come back with feathers on his lips, and I would say, "Cain, you have been eating the neighbors' chickens again, haven't you?"

He would say, "No," and a feather would fall out of his mouth.

That was his nature. He could not embrace the truth I was trying to teach him. It was outside his cycle and limitations.

But Chuck the duck was raised as a chicken. They tried to teach him how to scratch worms up and pick bugs up, and he nearly starved. One day he got near the pond. Though he had never seen ducks swim and did not know what ducks did, something inside said, "You can do that."

He ran and jumped in the water.

Why? Because his nature put him in capacity of it. He could discern it, understand it, and know he could do it. So he did it.

You are within range of God to worship Him in truth. When He says, "All things are possible to him that believeth," there is a part of you close enough to know you can do it.

It is truth. You can understand it. You can get close enough to operate in it and perform it. You can worship Him in that kind of truth because something in you tells you that you can.

Old Testament saints could not, but you can.

Worship in spirit and in truth are power twins. God will take the part of you that wants to understand Him and fellowship with Him, drive by, and drop you off within range of doing what He said you could do.

That is worshipping Him in the truth of what you are capable of in Him.

Do not abandon Him.

When you were born again, you received a spiritual mind as standard equipment for the new creation. That part of you craves truth. You want to know everything about God. You want to discern, understand, and be taught.

When He says all things are possible to him who believes, you hear that and know it is God. You have capacity to understand it. Your new nature has brought you close enough to receive it as truth and know that, in your case, it is possible.

That is in truth.

Along with the spiritual mind, you received the nature. That nature pools and reservoirs the love and compassion of God. It contains the attributes you want to operate out of.

Your spiritual mind can understand and inform, but your nature is the part that can reservoir and pool the unlimited supply of the absolute love and compassion of God.

He will fill you up. First you will get past the flesh. Then you will know it is His presence when He comes, and He will stay and stay. You cannot submit yourself to that kind of baptism without filling up.

When you stand in front of somebody and know that all things are possible to him who believes, you know what He said. You know you are capable, and you reach for them.

You are a faith person. Use your faith to stay in there until you are bigger than it is.

I can worship Him in truth because I know He can do anything, and I am going to stay there with Him.